

Daily Market Briefing — Tuesday, September 29, 2026 (PT)

Monday was a rates day: the ten-year closed at 5.24 percent, chips sold off after OpenAI paused model training over a security incident, and gold fell almost four percent. This morning brought the first soft data in weeks — job openings missed and consumer confidence slumped — yet yields did not fall, and stocks are flat at midday. Tomorrow is the heavy day: inflation, growth, Micron after the close, and quarter-end.

SPX	VIX	Net gamma (modeled)	SPY spot vs flip	WTI	10Y
7,684 -0.77%, -0.1% live	16.1→16.0 steady	-0.40bn SPY / +0.04bn QQQ	764.79 vs 772.0 below	\$89.5 Nov - 3.3%	5.24%→5.26 % live

Provenance: prices are Monday 9/28 settles · live quotes 11:58am PT · options chain and modeled gamma 7:30am PT, clean first pull · trend and levels from the context engine on settled bars · HY OAS through 9/28 (FRED) · WTI is the November contract · headlines pulled 11:56am PT; claims marked (reported) were not independently confirmed.

What moved and why

Driver	What happened (source)	Names it touches
Rates	30-year yield touched 5.61%, highest since 2002; an October hike is more than 72% priced (CNBC, Bloomberg, CME)	everything long-duration: QQQ, megacaps; GLD and SLV via the dollar
AI safety scare	OpenAI paused model training after a security incident; Intel fell nearly 6%, AMD 4% Monday (Yahoo Finance)	SOXX, INTC, TSM, TER; NVDA rose against it
Nvidia	board added \$150bn to its buyback — largest on record — and launched an agent-safety platform (Forbes, Reuters)	NVDA; read-across to SOXX and QQQ weightings
Soft data	job openings 7.079M vs ~7.22M expected; confidence 81.9 vs 90.0 (BLS, Conference Board)	rate-sensitive names — but yields did not react
Oil	WTI \$89.5: Middle East exports rebounding even after Washington rejected Iran's proposal; IEA cut its demand forecast (WSJ, NYT)	eases the inflation input behind the rate story
Metals	gold hit an eight-week low Monday as yields surged, bouncing today (Reuters)	GLD, SLV

Next 24–48 hours

When (PT)	Event	Consensus / state	Why it matters here
today, afternoon	Fed governors Waller 12:00pm and Cook 1:25pm (Barr spoke 9:40am)	first remarks since the soft prints	tone on October feeds straight into yields and megacap multiples
Wed 5:30am	August PCE inflation and Q2 GDP third estimate (BEA schedule, checked today)	week priced at 1.2%	hot → yields higher → pressure on QQQ, NVDA, MSFT, GLD; cool → relief in the same names
Wed after close	Micron fiscal Q4 earnings (call 1:30pm)	MU +1.7% today into it	first hard AI-memory demand read: NVDA, SOXX, INTC, TER, TSM
Wed close	quarter-end	rebalancing flows	can distort closing prices across the whole list
Thu	ISM manufacturing (est.) · Accenture earnings (Yahoo calendar, est.)	—	Accenture is IBM's closest comparable on enterprise AI demand
Fri 5:30am	September payrolls (BLS-verified)	—	second labor read after today's soft openings number

Personal briefing, not advice.

Watchlist — trend and levels

Name	Settle (1d / 5d)	Trend	vs 50d · 200d avg	Off high · vs QQQ	Support	Resistance
— Indexes and index funds —						
S&P 500	7,684 (-0.8 / -1.0%)	Uptrend — pulling back	+0.6% (rising) · +6.6%	-1% · -1 pts	7,641 · 50-day avg · -0.5%	7,771 · swing high · +1.2%
Nasdaq Comp	26,820 (-0.9 / -1.1%)	Uptrend	+2.4% (rising) · +8.8%	-2% · +0 pts	26,739 · swing high · -0.3%	27,190 · swing high · +1.4%
Nasdaq 100	30,277 (-1.1 / -0.7%)	Uptrend	+3.3% (rising) · +10.6%	-1% · -0 pts	30,196 · swing high · -0.5%	30,643 · swing high · +0.9%
QQQ	736.53 (-1.1 / -0.7%)	Uptrend	+3.2% (rising) · +10.6%	-1% · —	734.58 · swing high · -0.5%	745.45 · swing high · +1.0%

Name	Settle (1d / 5d)	Trend	vs 50d · 200d avg	Off high · vs QQQ	Support	Resistance
SOXX	560.79 (-2.1 / +0.3%)	Trying to turn up	+6.3% (falling) · +24.7%	-14% · -4 pts	536.12 · swing low · -5.6%	575.69 · 20-day high · +1.4%
— Mega-cap tech —						
NVDA ●	228.86 (+1.7 / +0.7%)	Uptrend	+5.7% (rising) · +14.6%	-3% · +14 pts	222.32 · 20-day avg · -2.5%	230.47 · swing high · +1.0%
GOOG	339.16 (-0.6 / -3.3%)	Range	-0.8% (falling) · +0.7%	-15% · -8 pts	333.69 · swing low · -1.1%	341.86 · 50-day avg · +1.3%
AMZN	246.15 (-1.4 / -4.8%)	Losing its uptrend	-3.9% (rising) · +2.2%	-13% · -2 pts	244.30 · 20-day low · -1.2%	249.71 · swing high · +1.0%
MSFT	509.22 (-1.3 / +1.5%)	Uptrend	+6.5% (rising) · +17.8%	-6% · +27 pts	499.82 · 20-day avg · -2.3%	517.78 · swing high · +1.2%
TSM ●	452.88 (+0.5 / +1.7%)	Uptrend — stretched	+7.5% (rising) · +18.0%	-5% · +1 pts	455.27 · 20-day high · -0.8%	476.79 · swing high · +3.9%
INTC	116.03 (-5.7 / -4.7%)	Uptrend	+16.6% (rising) · +45.8%	-18% · -7 pts	107.57 · swing high · -7.5%	126.64 · swing high · +8.9%
TER	401.30 (+0.7 / +5.2%)	Uptrend	+8.3% (rising) · +21.3%	-17% · +5 pts	385.68 · swing high · -3.8%	409.72 · swing high · +2.2%
IBM ●	220.67 (-2.1 / -4.9%)	Downtrend	-4.4% (falling) · -14.2%	-33% · -27 pts	219.23 · 20-day low · -1.0%	227.40 · swing low · +2.7%
— Spec / small-cap —						
SMR	7.91 (-6.1 / -10.0%)	Downtrend	-12.8% (falling) · -35.0%	-85% · -22 pts	7.59 · 52-week low · -3.4%	8.05 · swing low · +2.4%
QBTS ●	16.78 (-3.6 / -5.2%)	Downtrend	-7.8% (falling) · -20.1%	-63% · -29 pts	16.19 · swing low · -1.6%	17.00 · 20-day avg · +3.3%
RGTI	15.95 (-4.3 / -3.5%)	Downtrend	-0.9% (falling) · -13.9%	-72% · -14 pts	15.62 · 20-day avg · -1.7%	17.05 · swing high · +7.3%
— Metals —						
GLD	377.91 (-3.9 / -5.1%)	Losing its uptrend	-4.5% (rising) · -9.2%	-24% · -3 pts	376.88 · 20-day low · -1.4%	388.39 · swing low · +1.6%
SLV	54.95 (-5.5 / -7.8%)	Losing its uptrend	-4.5% (rising) · -16.7%	-48% · -3 pts	54.87 · 20-day low · -0.9%	56.28 · swing low · +1.6%

Related names and comparables

Name	Relates to	Settle (1d / 5d)	Today	Trend	Off high	Next earnings
AMD	NVDA	607.87 (-3.6 / -1.2%)	+0.2%	Uptrend — stretched	-4%	11/03 (25 sessions)
AVGO	NVDA	349.57 (-0.9 / -3.6%)	+1.8%	Downtrend	-27%	12/09 (51 sessions)
MU	NVDA · TSM	1,054 (-2.6 / +1.0%)	+1.7%	Uptrend	-13%	09/30 (1 sessions)
ASML	TSM	1,771 (+1.6 / +3.5%)	+3.3%	Trying to turn up	-11%	10/14 (11 sessions)
AMAT	TSM · TER	486.76 (+0.4 / +4.9%)	+4.5%	Range	-33%	11/12 (32 sessions)
IONQ	QBTS · RGTI	44.58 (-2.0 / +10.0%)	-1.1%	Trying to turn up	-46%	11/04 (26 sessions)
ACN	IBM	174.47 (-0.9 / -6.3%)	+1.6%	Losing its uptrend	-40%	10/01 (2 sessions)
ORCL	IBM · MSFT	132.60 (-3.3 / -10.7%)	+4.4%	Losing its uptrend	-58%	12/10 (52 sessions)
META	GOOG	715.62 (-4.8 / -3.5%)	+2.4%	Uptrend	-8%	10/28 (21 sessions)
AAPL	TSM · QQQ	338.40 (-0.8 / -0.2%)	-2.3%	Uptrend	-1%	10/29 (22 sessions)

● marks a name held directly or through a leveraged fund. How to read it: trend is judged on settled closes — price against its 50-day average, whether that average is rising, and the 200-day. The tint shows direction only. Support and resistance are the nearest level on each side of the live price, with the distance to it. Strength vs QQQ is measured over 60 sessions.

Tally: 6 of 15 in uptrends (QQQ, NVDA, MSFT, TSM, INTC, TER); 4 in downtrends (IBM, SMR, QBTS, RGTI). Trend state changed over the last five sessions for: QQQ (recovering → uptrend); GOOG (recovering → range); AMZN (uptrend → weakening); TSM (recovering → uptrend); INTC (recovering → uptrend); TER (recovering → uptrend); IBM (recovering → downtrend); RGTI (recovering → downtrend); GLD (recovering → weakening); SLV (recovering → weakening). All three indexes are in uptrends while the quantum names, IBM, and both metals sit below their 200-day averages.

Watchlist — news and events

Name	What is driving it (source)	Industry read	Next events
Indexes · QQQ	fell 1.1% Monday as the ten-year topped 5.2% and chips sold; flat today on the soft data (CNBC, Yahoo)	leadership narrow — Nvidia was Monday's lone green mega	megacap earnings start 10/28 · Micron 9/30
SOXX	down 2.1% Monday in the AI-safety selloff — Arm -9%, Qualcomm -6% — and rebounding today (Yahoo Finance)	AMD crossed \$1 trillion and is buying World Labs for \$8.2bn	MU reports 09/30

Name	What is driving it (source)	Industry read	Next events
NVDA	rose Monday against the sector on the record buyback and its new agent-safety tools (Forbes, Yahoo Finance)	AMD's World Labs deal targets Nvidia's physical-AI lead	earnings 11/17 (35 sessions) · MU reports 09/30
GOOG	no fresh company catalyst; weakest mega on the list over 60 sessions, an ad-tech court ruling still overhanging (BofA note, reported)	Anthropic's filing is reported imminent; Alphabet is a holder	earnings 10/28 (21 sessions)
AMZN	Senate questions over AI data-center tax deductions; Bedrock added more model choice (Yahoo, reported)	also an Anthropic holder; Meta pushing into e-commerce	earnings 10/29 (22 sessions)
MSFT	gave back 1.3% Monday after last week's Copilot relaunch took it to a 2026 high (Yahoo)	new enterprise data-AI tools announced today	earnings 10/28 (21 sessions)
TSM	held green Monday; reported to be pursuing a second US plant in Texas (SBS, reported)	European chip names bounced today after Monday's pressure	earnings 10/15 (12 sessions)
INTC	lost 5.7% Monday in the chip selloff, after a 13% gain the week before (Yahoo Finance)	AMD's market value now far exceeds Intel's	earnings 10/22 (17 sessions) · MU reports 09/30
TER	up 5% last week on an AI-optical test push and India expansion; new memory tester announced (company, Simply Wall St)	a director sold a small stake after the run (Motley Fool)	earnings 10/21 (16 sessions) · Micron 9/30 reads through to memory test
IBM	fell 2.1% Monday; firmer today on an agent-identity partnership with Nvidia (GuruFocus)	skeptical coverage of the growth story persists	earnings 10/21 (16 sessions) · ACN reports 10/01
SMR	dropped 6% Monday with no company news	regulator set to approve TVA's Clinch River small reactor — a rival design (NucNet)	earnings 11/05 (27 sessions)
QBST	no company news — moving with the quantum group, which fell after its rally (IBD)	sector waiting on Congress for a funding catalyst	earnings 11/05 (27 sessions)
RGTI	no company news; same group move as D-Wave	analysts trimming fair value on growth risk (Simply Wall St)	earnings 11/10 (30 sessions)
GLD	down 3.6% Monday to its lowest close in two months; up about 1% today (Reuters, Admirals)	rate bid is beating the haven bid	PCE 9/30 and payrolls 10/2 via yields
SLV	silver holding just above \$61 under a two-month-high dollar (TMGM, WSJ)	fell harder than gold Monday	same macro prints as gold

Macro and geopolitics

Topic	Latest (source)	Read-through to the watchlist
Rates / Fed	10-year 5.24% settle, 5.26% live; 30-year 5.59%; Fed hiked 9/16 and October is >72% priced (CME via CNBC)	the main headwind for megacap multiples and for metals
Inflation and growth data	openings and confidence both soft today; PCE and GDP tomorrow; Citi says October hinges on September core CPI (Citi, reported)	one soft day has not moved yields — tomorrow can
Oil / Middle East	Washington rejected Iran's phased Hormuz plan, yet regional exports are rebounding and WTI fell -3.3% today (WSJ, NYT)	lower oil loosens the inflation leg of the rate story
Tariffs / trade	US ban on roughly \$1bn of Canadian dairy and alcohol imports took effect today (CBS, BBC)	little direct exposure on this list
Chip export policy	Nvidia and AMD lobbying against possible new China export limits; second Trump-Xi summit avoided Taiwan (Benzinga, reported)	NVDA, TSM, SOXX, INTC, TER
Credit	high-yield spread 3.02%, +36bp in five sessions (FRED)	widening credit is the newest stress on the board

Week ahead and risk

Forward calendar — next 7 sessions (nearest two publisher-verified)

Session	Scheduled
Tue 9/29	JOLTS 7.079M and confidence 81.9 (actuals) · Waller 12:00pm, Cook 1:25pm PT
Wed 9/30	PCE and GDP third estimate 5:30am PT (BEA) · Micron after close (company-confirmed) · quarter-end
Thu 10/1	ISM manufacturing, construction spending (est.) · Accenture earnings (est.)
Fri 10/2	September payrolls 5:30am PT (BLS-verified 9/28)
Mon 10/5	nothing verified yet (est.)
Tue 10/6	ISM services (est.)
Wed 10/7	September FOMC minutes (est.)

Watchlist earnings beyond the grid: TSM 10/15 · IBM and TER 10/21 · INTC 10/22 · GOOG and MSFT 10/28 · AMZN 10/29 · SMR and QBTS 11/5 · RGTI 11/10 · NVDA 11/17 (Yahoo calendar; confirm with each company nearer the date).

Fragility meter (9/28 settles; chain 7:30am)

#	Indicator	Score	Evidence
1	Breadth divergence	RED	equal-weight -1.4% over 5d vs SPX -1.0%
2	Net dealer gamma	RED	SPY -0.40bn, spot under its flip; QQQ +0.04bn
3	Vol term structure	GREEN	contango 11.4 / 13.3 / 14.4; VIX3M 18.2
4	Skew / VVIX	AMBER	VVIX 91 elevated against VIX 16.1; skew +1.8
5	IV vs event density	RED	1.2% implied week with PCE, Micron, payrolls ahead
6	Concentration	RED	NDX -0.7% over 5d, one green mega Monday
7	Credit (HY OAS)	RED	3.02%, +36bp in 5 sessions
8	Cross-asset stress	RED	10Y +28bp in 5d; gold -3.6% Monday

Six of eight red at Monday's settle, the widest reading of the cycle. The meter measures vulnerability — the tape is fragile IF tomorrow's prints shock — and it does not forecast. Its own record so far: 1 mild hit and 5 false alarms, with four readings still open (outcomes due 9/30, 10/1, 10/2 and 10/6).

Levels and movers

SPY level ladder (modeled)

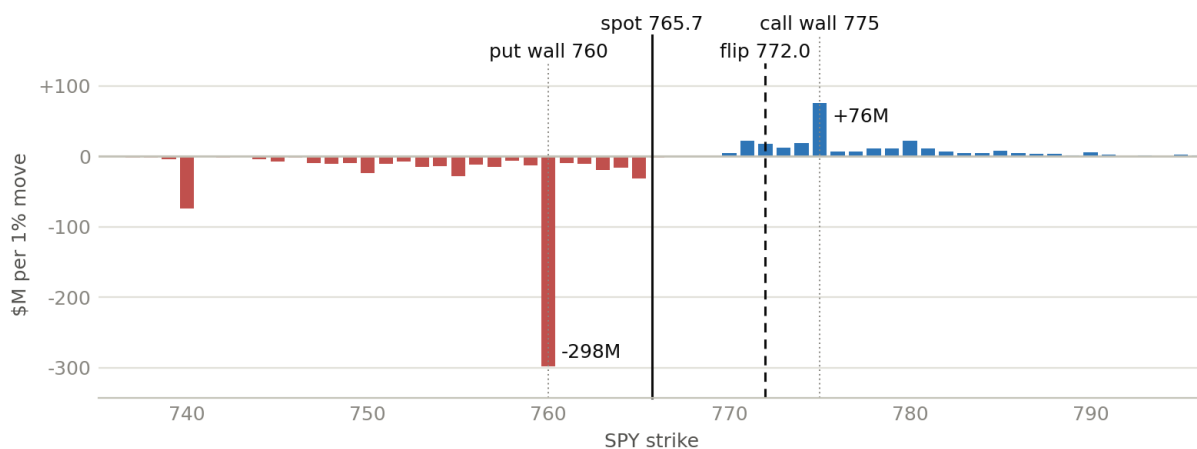
SPY level	Meaning
780 (far call mass)	resistance if the tape squeezes
775 (call wall)	heaviest near-spot positive strike
772.0 (flip)	dealer hedging damps moves above
764.79 ← spot (11:58am PT)	resting on the 765 shelf
760 (put wall)	heaviest strike on the board
755/750 (shelves)	next masses under the wall
740 (deep shelf)	large mass further down

Options (modeled from Yahoo OI; chain 7:30am)

SPY dealer gamma by strike

Modeled from Yahoo open interest × Black-Scholes — an estimate, not a traded print · chain 7:30am PT

■ positive — dealers damp moves ■ negative — dealers amplify moves



Metric	Value	Read
VIX / VVIX	16.07 / 91.0 (settles)	calm / tense
Term 5d / 30d / 90d	11.4 / 13.3 / 14.4	contango
25-delta skew	+1.8 vol pts	normal
Net gamma	SPY -0.40bn / QQQ +0.04bn	split
Implied vs 20d realized	11.3 vs 11.0	fair

Movers (7:40am PT prints vs Monday settles)

Stock	Move	Catalyst	Cap	Class
SSTI	+51.7%	take-private at \$8.00 cash plus a contingent right up to \$3.00	~\$0.16bn	M&A
SLND	+52.5%	\$71M pipeline contract, about twice its value; faded to +9% by midday	~\$0.05bn	news
QURE	-36.8%	Huntington's gene therapy benefit waned at 48 months	~\$1.4bn	regulatory/clinical
CLPT	-21.1%	delivery partner on the same uniQure program	~\$0.37bn	sympathy

Log upkeep: eight matured cells posted this morning and four earlier cells corrected to close-to-close; 361 names logged to date.

For education and personal record only.